

Post-incident review PIR-2025-030

Mobile Backend: elevated error rates

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 13 June 2025, Mobile Backend experienced elevated error rates in production (Southeast Asia) for about 240 minutes. The end-to-end checkout probe went red. Investigation found that the client certificate used for the partner integration was not renewed.

Impact

Users of Mobile Backend saw elevated error rates for about 240 minutes. The service owner, Mobile Engineering, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:18 First signal received.
- 09:34 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:45 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:33 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the client certificate used for the partner integration was not renewed.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

The change was made outside the approved maintenance window.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.